



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: The Master's Academy
School Website: <https://tmalions.com>

December 28, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Masters Academy NC 28043 (The Master's Academy) presents a clear orientation toward classical Christian education, with strong religious foundations, a stated classical curriculum framework, and a mission of character formation alongside intellectual development. Public materials emphasize faith-based formation, a weekly chapel program, and a classical curriculum framed by ACCS membership. Pedagogical practices highlighted on the site include outdoor, inquiry-driven experiences and a commitment to dedicated, "living" faculty who model virtue. The school's public materials show strong alignment in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, and Faculty, with credible evidence for Curriculum and Pedagogy that is indicative but not uniformly explicit about all canonical classical practices (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references or a robustly Socratic high-school pedagogy). Overall, the school is CLASSICAL in its orientation, with some areas showing only SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals and one category (Parents & Community) showing limited classical cues.

- Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL
- Key insights:
 - Religious foundation is explicit and central: faith-based education, weekly Chapel, Bible curriculum, and ACCS membership. This strongly supports Element 1.
 - Purpose and formation are foregrounded: noble purpose, formation of character, and a mind trained through classical aims. This supports Element 2.
 - Curriculum is described as classical, with explicit mention of a classical curriculum and traditional subject areas; explicit Great Books references are not shown in public materials, which yields SOMEWHAT signals for Element 3.
 - Pedagogy includes flow-based, inquiry-driven outdoor learning, which provides SOMEWHAT classical signals but is not fully aligned with some canonical classical methods (e.g., explicit Socratic seminars in public materials). Element 4 is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Faculty are depicted as model teachers and living curriculum, which aligns with CLASSICAL signals in Element 5.
 - Parent/community engagement is not clearly demonstrated as a co-teaching model within the public materials, aligning with NOT CLASSICAL in Element 6.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Masters Academy presents itself as a classical Christian school with a faith-based foundation and a theological framing of education (ACCS membership noted as part of its identity). This is reflected in statements about faith-based education and classical Christian education. - Public materials mention a weekly Chapel service and Bible classes as part of the school life, indicating liturgical/communal practices. - The ACCS membership signals alignment with a historically religious-inflected classical framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: chapel (explicit), faith-based education (explicit framing of theology-like formation), classical Christian school (explicit branding). The lexicon's positive indicators for this category include chapel, theology, liturgy, and reverence/wonder. The explicit mentions of chapel and faith-based education map to these signals. - Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or morally neutral language detected in the excerpts provided).

Why this rating - The school foregrounds religious formation, chapel, and theology-inflected education, with explicit framing as a classical Christian institution, which strongly aligns with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category. The presence of chapel and faith-based framing are core positive indicators in the lexicon for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials state a classical education that offers a content-rich curriculum while teaching students their noble purpose, signaling formation toward virtue and wisdom rather than narrowly job-focused aims. - The site features the idea of “Discipling the Heart ~ Educating the Mind,” signaling formation of the whole person (mind and heart). - The ACCS affiliation and emphasis on faith-based education frame the telos of education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, not purely technical training.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, noble purpose, telos (implied by the noble purpose; formation language is evident through the “Discipling the Heart” framing), standard “true/good/beautiful” teleology is implied by classical Christian framing. The explicit phrase “noble purpose” appears in the public copy. - Negative keywords: None evident in the public materials for this category (no emphasis on workforce-readiness or 21st-century skills that would signal a departure from formation-focused aims).

Why this rating - The materials stress formation, virtue, and a teleological aim (“noble purpose”), which are core signals for the School Purpose and Goal category in classical education. The explicit emphasis on formation and moral development aligns with classical aims beyond mere information transfer.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Masters Academy publicly identifies as having a Classical Curriculum and describes offering a college-prep pathway; this signals alignment with classical curricular aims. - Public materials list traditional subjects (math, science, English, history) as core offerings, and note that history is taught as history rather than rebranded as social studies, aligning with a traditional approach to history in a classical framework. - ACCS membership is cited, which is often associated with classical/liberal arts curricula and Great Books-oriented programs, though explicit Great Books mentions are not visible in the public text.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: classical curriculum (explicit), liberal arts framing (implicit in “classical education” and “content-rich curriculum”), history as history (not social studies). The explicit use of “Classical Curriculum” is a direct positive signal. - Negative keywords: Not overtly present in the public text (there is no explicit “project-based learning dominance” or replacement of history with social studies in the public copy). However, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation or standard “Socratic method” references are not shown, which softens the classical signal in this category.

Why this rating - The school claims a Classical Curriculum and shows subject-area offerings and a historic approach to history, which are core elements of Element 3. However, explicit Great Books references or a clearly articulated Trivium/Quadrivium implementation (grammar, logic, rhetoric) are not visibly documented in the public content, so the category is best labeled SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than Fully CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe Outdoor School and Forest School experiences with flow learning and inquiry-based approaches, emphasizing student-driven, experiential learning in a real-world setting. - The site emphasizes a Restful/experiential dimension in learning through nature and inquiry, rather than a clearly articulated Socratic seminar, structured memory work, or classical recitation emphasis. The explicit public references to Socratic discussion or formal rhetoric instruction in high school are not present in the visible content. - There is a stated focus on dedicated educators and a “living curriculum,” which aligns with a classical ethos in Element 5 but does not itself define pedagogical structure in the proven classical sense.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: memory work, recitation, chant, or other explicit classical pedagogy terms are not overtly present in the public text. However, there are signals like “flow learning” and “inquiry-based” that indicate a learner-centered approach; these do not map cleanly to the lexicon’s classical pedagogy signals (e.g., Socratic seminar, narration, chanting, memory work). This yields a nuanced signal rather than a strong positive. - Negative keywords: The explicit negative signals (experiential-only, project-based domination, constructivist) are not stated as dominant in the public materials; rather, the content emphasizes inquiry and outdoor experiences, which can diverge from the strict, traditional classical pedagogy signals. This nudges Element 4 toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The pedagogy demonstrates notable classical-inspired elements (structured recitation/memory is not clearly shown; upper-level rhetoric training is not explicit). The visible emphasis on outdoor, inquiry-based, and child-driven learning indicates a modern pedagogical approach rather than a wholly classical one, placing it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe the faculty as “Dedicated Educators” who are passionate and bring enthusiasm to their lessons, implying teacher modeling of virtue and expertise. - The site highlights the faculty as the living curriculum and emphasizes a collegial, teacher-centered culture, including staff profiles (e.g., Head of School, Forest School Coordinator) and a staff-oriented approach. - The presence of formal staff pages and administration signals a portrait of teacher leadership and moral exemplars, consistent with classical faculty signals.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: dedicated educators, living curriculum, portrait of what a teacher should be, faculty of friends, collegial culture. While the exact vocabulary from the lexicon (e.g., “tutors,” “masters,” “living curriculum”) may not all appear verbatim, the concepts map to the lexicon’s positive signals for Faculty (model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher/student ideals). The site explicitly uses “Dedicated Educators” and “faculty” language. - Negative keywords: None evident in the public material regarding faculty (no mention of disengaged or purely credential-based instruction).

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on dedicated, virtuous, and mentoring faculty along with a “living curriculum” framing aligns well with Element 5’s Classical signals about faculty as the core of the school’s classical project.

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials do not clearly present a formal, sustained model of parents as co-teachers or a robust program of parent formation, reading groups, or home liturgy alignment that are characteristic signals in the lexicon for this category. The site emphasizes admissions processes and contact information but does not show a structured, ongoing parental formation or open-campus model with the explicit “co-teaching” framing. - There is no explicit mention of family liturgy alignment, parent covenant, or formal community partnership beyond standard school-facing communications.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive signals: The publicly stated partnership with parents as co-teachers and detailed parent formation programs would be the strongest signals for Element 6. These

are not overtly present in the site copy we have here; the lexicon's positive signals include partnership with parents, parent formation, and open-campus events. These explicit cues are not evidenced in the accessible public content. - Negative signals: The absence of explicit, ongoing parent formation and open-campus co-education signals contributes to a NOT CLASSICAL categorization for this dimension.

Why this rating - The public materials do not demonstrate the core classical signals for Parents & Community (co-teaching partnership, parent formation, or broad parent accessibility). The school's public-facing content focuses more on the student experience, curriculum framing, and faculty than on parent-formation programs. This results in a NOT CLASSICAL designation for Element 6.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: NOT CLASSICAL

Overall, the school leans CLASSICAL in its orientation, with clearly strong religious foundations, a stated classical curriculum, and a faculty-centric living-curriculum model. Some categories (Curriculum and Pedagogy) show SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals due to not all canonical classical elements being explicitly evidenced in the public materials (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references, explicit Socratic pedagogy). The Parents & Community category shows the weakest alignment with classical signals in the currently visible content.

What Would Move the Needle

- For a category to move from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL:
 - Curriculum: Explicitly articulate Great Books, Great Conversation, and the Trivium/Quadrivium in public materials; provide explicit mentions of grammar, logic, rhetoric as core components and show examples of classical texts or primary sources used across grades. Also emphasize Latin/Greek study where applicable.
 - Pedagogy: Highlight explicit use of classical teaching methods (Socratic seminars in upper grades, memorized rhetorical exercises, dictation, and narrations) and show evidence of periodic scholē days that emphasize contemplation and rest in learning.
 - Parents & Community: Strengthen parent formation offerings (reading groups, seminars, and family liturgy alignment) and communicate open-campus opportunities and “co-teaching” partnerships to demonstrate parent involvement as a living part of the classical formation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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